

Climate change

Glacier National Park, Montana

In this center of climate change research, the glaciers have been retreating since the end of the Little Ice Age—a cool period ending in 1850. The shrinking has accelerated recently and experts think it is due to artificial global warming.

Greenland ice sheet

In an average summer, ice melts on about 20 percent of the surface of Greenland's ice sheet. At one point in the summer of 2012, scientists observed that 97 percent of the surface was melting.

**GLACIER
NATIONAL PARK,
MONTANA, NOW HAS
ONLY 25 GLACIERS.
IN 1910, THERE
WERE 150**

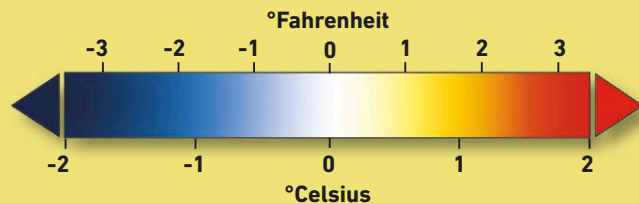
Earth's climate has been warming and cooling for millions of years. But in the last century, the planet has been warming rapidly. Scientists widely accept that this warming is linked with carbon dioxide and other gases released by human industry, transportation, and other activities. The gases trap outgoing heat in Earth's atmosphere, warming the planet.

Warming oceans

Satellite measurements show that the Southern Ocean is warming by 0.4°F (0.2°C) per decade—much more rapidly than other oceans.

TEMPERATURE CHANGE

This map, produced by scientists at NASA, shows the 5-year average global temperature for the years 2013–17, compared to temperatures for the years 1950–80. Regions that are hotter in 2013–17 than they were in the earlier period are shaded red. Those that are now colder appear blue.



● Other evidence of climate change